

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 15, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m8a-y87m-fqyp
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001
Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479
Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-5132
Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Name: Anonymous Anonymous

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

AIActionPlanComment

March 15, 2025

From:
Aaron
Illustrator

Re: National Science Foundation's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

I am a freelance illustrator who does contract and gig work for various clients in the entertainment industry, across many mediums that all center around visual arts. Recently, my already precarious job has been made even worse due to big tech companies threatening my livelihood. I've worked so hard for so long to develop my specialized skills to work in the entertainment industry, and it is beyond disappointing to see that our country's leaders seem to be so prepared to throw all my work, and years and money put into education, under the bus to benefit companies that make their money off of the labor of myself and my peers in the industry.

The AI systems made by Big Tech companies like OpenAI (Microsoft) and Google threaten to destroy thousands of American small businesses and freelancers like me with their demand to create special carve outs in copyright law. Why should the law not apply to Big Tech? What about me and others like me, whose hard work they have stolen? What laws will protect us?

AI systems can only be produced by first training on work made by people. My unique work, and the work of hundreds of thousands of other everyday American creators was taken and fed into these AI systems without our consent or any compensation. They ingest our work, reassemble it, and then sell it back to our clients – directly competing with us and cutting us out of the marketplace.

Now these Big Tech companies are asking this administration to create exceptions and loopholes to make this practice of stealing American creators' copyrighted work legal precedent. They are suggesting that if a machine ingests copyrighted work, it is somehow suddenly "fair use".

They seem to believe that anything and everything on the internet – regardless of who owns it – should be theirs for the taking. They claim that if this administration does not allow them to rewrite the law in this way, it will stifle American innovation.

Instead, it will have the opposite effect. The purpose of American copyright law is to protect the incentive to create and innovate.

If we the American people do not own our creations, and everything we put online will be stolen by Big Tech giants, what will be the incentive to create? If everyday Americans create a new

innovative piece of computer code, a new visual design, or a new piece of music only to have it immediately stolen by Google and Microsoft, why bother creating it in the first place? How will we possibly make a living doing these things? How can small businesses compete with Big Tech like that? I thought part of the American Dream was that anyone can start a business and find success, and that success will be protected by the law.

Want to protect American innovation? Protect American creators. **Do not create new copyright exemptions that allow Big Tech companies to exploit and steal from creators and everyday Americans without permission, compensation, or transparency.**

This administration's AI Action Plan should focus not on giving away creator content to Big Tech companies, but rather on ensuring a fair marketplace with competition:

- First, the government should ensure that creators and everyday Americans give effective **consent**, so that we can decide when and where our work is used by AI systems.
- Second, the AI Action Plan should encourage a robust **licensing** marketplace, so that the incentive to create for small businesses is preserved. Our work has immense economic value, so the value generated by that work should accrue to the original creators, not just Big Tech.
- Finally, the AI Action Plan should require **transparency** from Big Tech companies, requiring them to disclose what material is in their training datasets, and label what content is AI generated.

I am not anti-technology or anti-AI. I am consistently impressed by the capabilities of these AI systems, and find them incredibly useful for many things. But we should not sacrifice the hard work of hundreds of thousands of Americans and give it away to Big Tech by rewriting copyright law.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on these important issues.